

CraftRoots

User Personas & Empathy Maps

Understanding Our Travelers & Artisans

Where travelers become makers, and artisans become hosts.

Persona 1: Priya Sharma

Age: 34 years | **Location:** Bangalore, India | **Role:** UX Designer

ABOUT

- Urban Professional
- Weekend Explorer
- Instagram Enthusiast

MOTIVATIONS

- Looking for unique weekend getaways from Bangalore
- Wants authentic experiences, not tourist traps
- Interested in learning traditional crafts hands-on
- Seeks content-worthy experiences for social media

GOALS

- Book a pottery workshop in Khurja for next weekend
- Learn block printing in Jaipur during upcoming trip
- Find verified artisans with good reviews
- Create handmade souvenirs instead of buying mass-produced items

PAIN POINTS

- Can't find authentic craft experiences on mainstream platforms
- Unsure about quality and safety of unverified workshops
- Difficulty communicating with artisans directly
- Last-minute planning leaves no time for research

PERSONALITY

Adventurous: 85% | Detail-Oriented: 90% | Social: 75% | Budget-Conscious: 60% | Spontaneous: 70%

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Smartphone Usage: 95% | Online Booking: 90% | Social Media: 85% | Digital Payments: 80% | Travel Planning Apps: 75%

Empathy Map: Priya Sharma

The Urban Weekend Explorer

SAYS	THINKS
"I need a break from Bangalore this weekend." "I want to learn something, not just take photos." "Why can't I find real craft experiences on MakeMyTrip?" "My friends will love this if I post it." "I'd rather make my own souvenir than buy one."	"Will this actually be authentic or just another tourist trap?" "I hope the workshop is Instagram-worthy." "What if the artisan doesn't speak English?" "Is it safe to book something I found randomly online?" "Last-minute planning is so stressful."
DOES	FEELS
• Scrolls Instagram for travel inspiration on Thursday night • Searches Google for 'pottery workshops near Bangalore' • Books experiences 2-3 days before the trip • Posts stories and reels during and after the workshop • Pays premium for convenience and uniqueness	• Excited but anxious about authenticity • Frustrated when results show only product stores • Overwhelmed by lack of verified options • Proud when she creates something with her own hands • Disappointed when an experience feels staged

Persona 2: Mark Thompson

Age: 42 years | **Location:** London, UK | **Role:** Travel Journalist

ABOUT

- International Traveler
- Cultural Writer
- Slow Travel Advocate

MOTIVATIONS

- Researching India's living craft traditions for publication
- Seeks deep cultural immersion beyond surface tourism
- Wants to understand craft techniques from master artisans
- Looking for untold stories of artisan communities

GOALS

- Document Warli painting traditions in Maharashtra
- Spend full day with blue pottery artisans in Jaipur
- Build relationships with artisan families for long-term stories
- Find workshops that allow photography and detailed observation

PAIN POINTS

- Mainstream tours offer only superficial craft demonstrations
- Language barriers prevent meaningful artisan conversations
- No platform connects directly to rural craft clusters
- Difficulty verifying artisan credentials and craft authenticity

PERSONALITY

Curious: 95% | Patient: 90% | Analytical: 85% | Independent: 80% | Culturally Sensitive: 95%

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Smartphone Usage: 70% | Online Booking: 85% | Social Media: 60% | Digital Payments: 75% | Travel Planning Apps: 80%

Empathy Map: Mark Thompson

The International Cultural Deep-Diver

SAYS	THINKS
"I'm not interested in the Taj Mahal—show me the weavers." "I need three full days in this village, not a 2-hour demo." "Can I photograph the entire process?" "My readers want the untold stories." "I don't want a guide—I want a conversation."	"How do I know this artisan is the real master, not a performer?" "Language will be a barrier, but body language is universal." "Mainstream tourism has destroyed the authenticity of most craft towns." "I hope the artisan family trusts me enough to open up." "Is there any platform that connects me directly to rural artisans?"
DOES	FEELS
• Researches academic papers and ethnographic studies before trips • Spends hours in a single workshop observing silently • Takes detailed notes and photographs with permission • Returns to the same artisan multiple times over years • Pays artisans directly and generously	• Deeply curious but skeptical of packaged experiences • Respected when artisans treat him as a learner, not a tourist • Frustrated when workshops are shortened for 'tourist convenience' • Connected when genuine relationships form • Guilty when he realizes how little middlemen pay them

Persona 3: Ramesh Patel

Age: 58 years | **Location:** Ahmedabad, Gujarat | **Role:** Kutch Embroidery Artisan

ABOUT

- Master Craftsman
- Rural Artisan
- Family Breadwinner

MOTIVATIONS

- Earn fair income without middlemen taking majority share
- Pass on embroidery skills to interested learners
- Gain recognition as cultural host, not just product seller
- Build direct relationships with customers who value craft

GOALS

- Host 3-4 traveler workshops per week during season
- Earn 2-3× more per session than selling finished pieces
- Build reputation through positive customer reviews
- Reduce dependency on wholesale middlemen

PAIN POINTS

- Middlemen pay only 20-30% of final product price
- No direct access to customers who visit nearby towns
- Lacks digital literacy to create online presence
- Unpredictable income from seasonal product orders

PERSONALITY

Traditional: 90% | Hospitable: 95% | Skilled Teacher: 85% | Cautious: 70% | Pride in Craft: 100%

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Smartphone Usage: 40% | Online Booking: 20% | Social Media: 15% | Digital Payments: 35% | Travel Planning Apps: 10%

Empathy Map: Ramesh Patel

The Artisan Host

SAYS	THINKS
"My grandmother taught me this stitch when I was eight." "The trader pays me ₹150 for a piece that sells for ₹800 in Delhi." "I can teach if someone brings the students to me." "My daughter says I should be on 'the internet.'" "I don't want to sell products—I want to share my knowledge."	"Will these city people respect my craft or just treat it as entertainment?" "I have skills worth teaching, but no one knows I exist." "Technology is not for people like me." "What if they book and don't show up? I lose a whole day's work." "Will they understand why this pattern means protection in our culture?"
DOES	FEELS
• Wakes at 4 AM to embroider before household duties • Sells through the same trader his father and grandfather used • Teaches neighboring children traditional stitches informally • Hesitates to use the smartphone his son bought him • Prepares chai and snacks for any visitor to his workshop	• Proud of his craft but invisible in the modern economy • Trapped by dependency on middlemen • Hopeful when travelers show genuine interest • Anxious about digital payments and online trust • Hospitable by nature but cautious about exploitation

Persona 4: Ananya Reddy

Age: 28 years | **Location:** Hyderabad, India | **Role:** Marketing Manager

ABOUT

- Heritage Route Planner
- Family Trip Organizer
- Experience Collector

MOTIVATIONS

- Planning heritage road trip for parents' 30th anniversary
- Wants meaningful family activities, not just sightseeing
- Interested in multi-generational craft learning experiences
- Seeks activities suitable for both parents and young niece

GOALS

- Find Madhubani painting workshop in Bihar suitable for all ages
- Book multiple craft experiences along Rajasthan route
- Ensure safety and comfort for elderly parents
- Create shared family memories through hands-on activities

PAIN POINTS

- Difficult to find age-inclusive craft workshops
- No information about accessibility or physical demands
- Uncertainty about hygiene and safety standards
- Group booking options unclear on most platforms

PERSONALITY

Organized: 95% | Family-Centered: 100% | Safety-Conscious: 90% | Research-Driven: 85% | Value-Seeker: 75%

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Smartphone Usage: 90% | Online Booking: 85% | Social Media: 70% | Digital Payments: 80% | Travel Planning Apps: 90%

Empathy Map: Ananya Reddy

The Family Heritage Trip Planner

SAYS	THINKS
"I need something my parents AND my niece can enjoy together." "Safety and hygiene are non-negotiable for my parents." "I want this trip to be memorable, not just another vacation." "Can we book the entire workshop just for our family?" "I need to plan this two months in advance."	"What if the workshop is too physically demanding for my father?" "Why is there no information about wheelchair access or clean restrooms?" "Group booking discounts should be transparent." "What if the artisan gets annoyed with my niece's questions?" "I wish I could see photos of the actual workshop space, not stock images."
DOES	FEELS
• Creates detailed Excel itineraries with backup plans • Reads 20+ reviews before booking anything • Calls venues directly to ask about accessibility • Books private sessions even if more expensive • Documents the trip in a shared family photo album	• Organized but stressed by information gaps • Protective of her family's comfort and experience • Frustrated when platforms lack family-specific filters • Relieved when an experience exceeds her research expectations • Joyful when she sees her parents and niece learning together

Persona 5: Sofia Martinez

Age: 31 years | **Location:** Barcelona, Spain | **Role:** Sustainable Fashion Designer

ABOUT

- Ethical Sourcing Seeker
- Craft Researcher
- Solo Female Traveler

MOTIVATIONS

- Sourcing authentic Indian crafts for sustainable fashion line
- Learning traditional techniques to adapt for modern design
- Building ethical supply chain with artisan communities
- Understanding craft sustainability and preservation challenges

GOALS

- Learn cane weaving techniques in Assam for bag collection
- Study Channapatna lacquerware for toy design inspiration
- Establish long-term partnerships with artisan cooperatives
- Document techniques for design team back in Barcelona

PAIN POINTS

- No reliable way to find authentic craft clusters in rural India
- Concerned about safety as solo female traveler in remote areas
- Difficulty assessing craft quality and scalability potential
- Language barriers complicate technical discussions

PERSONALITY

Purpose-Driven: 95% | Independent: 90% | Culturally Curious: 100% | Professional: 85% | Risk-Aware: 80%

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Smartphone Usage: 85% | Online Booking: 90% | Social Media: 75% | Digital Payments: 80% | Travel Planning Apps: 85%

Empathy Map: Sofia Martinez

The Ethical Sourcing Professional

SAYS	THINKS
"I need to understand the technique before I adapt it." "Can I see the raw materials and the full process?" "I'm not here to buy one piece—I want a partnership." "My design team in Barcelona needs detailed documentation." "Fair trade is not enough—I need direct trade."	"Is this artisan community actually benefiting, or am I just extracting knowledge?" "Solo female traveler in rural India—what are the real risks?" "How do I assess if this craft can scale ethically?" "Language barriers will limit how deep I can go technically." "Most 'artisan' labels in Europe are marketing lies. I want proof."
DOES	FEELS
• Researches NGO reports and craft cluster studies before visiting • Carries a translator app and hires local interpreters • Documents every step with photos, videos, and sketches • Negotiates long-term contracts, not one-off purchases • Shares profits and credits openly with artisan partners	• Purpose-driven but burdened by ethical responsibility • Isolated when she cannot communicate directly with artisans • Inspired by traditional techniques but anxious about appropriation • Conflicted about commercializing sacred or traditional motifs • Fulfilled when partnerships create sustainable income for families